Polydefinites as Markers of Prominence: A Unified Analysis of Greek Polydefinites[1]

Stergios Chatzykiriakidis
University of Crete

Giorgos Spathas
ZAS Berlin

Abstract. In this paper we argue against the assumption that the main semantic contribution of Greek polydefinites is restrictive interpretation. To be more precise, we argue that the preference for a restrictive interpretation with polydefinites is a special case of a more general property associated with polydefinites: prominence marking in the sense of Von Heusinger and Schumacher (2019). Once this assumption is made, not only the classic restrictive interpretation is explained, but also felicitous uses of polydefiniteness where a restrictive interpretation fails, which have been puzzling in the literature. Our interpretation is reinforced by data collection that shows that cases of non-restrictive interpretations are too many to be ignored as under the traditional view. We also provide novel evidence that the stated restrictions on the distribution of adjectives in polydefinites are too strict; virtually all types of adjectival modification are permitted in polydefiniteness with the right contextual support. Since no existing analysis captures this new empirical picture, we propose a new apposition-based analysis of polydefiniteness (cf. Lekakou and and Szendrői 2012), cast in the framework of Dynamic Syntax. Under our proposal the truth-conditional contribution of a polydefinite DP is identical to that of the corresponding monadic definite. The contribution of polydefiniteness is instead discourse-structural.

Keywords: polydefinites, Greek, Prominence, restrictivity, apposition

1. Introduction

Polydefinites are definite descriptions with adjectival modifiers in which definite determiners accompany both the noun *N* and one or more adjective *A*, as in (1a) and (1b). In the corresponding monadic definite in (1c), a single determiner appears.

(1)	a.	i	mavres	i	jates			*polydefinites*
		the	black	the	cats			
	b.	i	mavres	i	anisihes	i	jates	
		the	black	the	anxious	the	cats	
	c.	i	mavres	anisihes	jates			*monadic definite*
		the	black	anxious	cats			

Whereas polydefinites and monadic definites behave similarly in that they both pick up a single referent (i.e. the additional determiners do not appear to contribute additional definiteness semantics), they have been claimed to differ both in their syntactic behaviour (most notably in that polydefinites make available word-order variants not attested with monadics) and other semantico-pragmatic properties. This paper focuses on the latter, and particularly on a property that large part of the literature takes to be a direct and unavoidable consequence of polydefiniteness. Polydefinites have been argued to necessarily give rise to a restrictive interpretation. As such, use of a polydefinite DP with noun *N* and adjective *A* in a context *c* is argued to necessarily give rise to the inference that some *N* in *c* is not *A*.[2] Evidence for this comes from contrasts like the one in (2), where the polydefinite version in (2b) is claimed to require that the adjective is interpreted restrictively. So, whereas (2a) is felicitous in a context where all students are naughty and will be punished (a non-restrictive interpretation), (2b) is

[1] Acknowledgements: hidden for review purposes.
[2] This is a simplified version of the definition of restrictivity in Katz (2008: 21, (20)). Katz investigates restrictivity in Romance definites (which are monadic) and treats the inference as an implicature.

argued to be infelicitous in such a context and only felicitous in a context in which only some of the students are naughty and will be punished (a restrictive interpretation) (Kolliakou 2004).

(2) a. I dhiefthindria apofasise i atakti mathites na epanalavun
the principal decided the naughty students to repeat
tin eksetasi.
the exam
'The principal decided that the naughty students will repeat the exam.'
b. I dhiefthindria apofasise i atakti i mathites na epanalavun
the principal decided the naughty the students to repeat
tin eksetasi.
the exam
'The principal decided that the naughty students will repeat the exam.'

Similarly, the alleged contrast between (3) and (4) has been argued by Kolliakou (2004:216-217) to demonstrate the obligatory restrictive interpretation of polydefinites. It is argued there that, whereas the monadic *i mikres gates* 'the small cats' in (3) allows both the restrictive interpretations in (a) and (b) and the non-restrictive interpretations in (c) and (d), the polydefinite version *i mikres i gates* 'the small cats' in (4) is argued to only allow the restrictive interpretations in (a) and (b).[3]

(3) O Yannis taise ta zoa. I mikres gates itan pinasmenes.
the Yannis fed the animals the young cats were hungry
'John fed the animals. The young cats were hungry.'
(a) All the animals John fed were cats, and there were young and non-young cats.
(b) John fed cats and non-cats, and there were young and non-young cats.
(c) All the animals John fed were cats, and there were only young cats.
(d) John fed cats and non-cats, and all the cats were young ones.

(4) O Yannis taise ta zoa. I mikres i gates itan pinasmenes.
the Yannis fed the animals the young the cats were hungry
'John fed the animals. The young cats were hungry.'
(a) All the animals John fed were cats, and there were young and non-young cats.
(b) John fed cats and non-cats, and there were young and non-young cats.

Polydefiniteness is also claimed to be unavailable in cases where a (normally restrictive) adjective does not restrict the denotation of the noun (Kolliakou 2004, 274, (13d)). This the case in, e.g., (5) since all cobras are poisonous.

(5) #Idha tis dhilitiriodhis tis kobres.
saw.I the venomous the cobras
'I saw the venomous cobras.'

The obligatory association of polydefinites with restrictive interpretations is also claimed to explain reported restrictions in the adjectives that are allowed to appear in the construction. Although there are notable exceptions, which we discuss in section 2, the majority of the literature agrees that only modifiers that can be interpreted as restrictive modifiers are licit in

[3] We will challenge this assessment of these and similar facts in section 3.

polydefinites. Kolliakou (2004: 264, (3)) exemplifies with the modal non-subsective adjective *ipotithemenos* 'alleged' in (6).[4]

(6) *i ipotithemeni i tromokrates
the alleged the terrorists
'the alleged terrorists'

Most accounts derive restrictiveness from the syntax-semantics of polydefiniteness. In such accounts polydefinites are treated as distinct structures from monadic definites; more usually they are assumed to instantiate some type of DP-internal predicational structure that necessarily leads to a restrictive interpretation. This is a very prominent type of analysis in the relevant literature, although the exact details can vary a lot. A summarized by Alexiadou (2014) (cf. Campos & Stavrou 2004, Alexiadou 2007), given these empirical and analytical commitments, the distribution of adjectives in polydefinites is described as in (7).

(7) The possibility of an adjective to appear across the copula in a predicative clause is a necessary but not a sufficient condition for its felicitous participation in a multi-definite construction. What is additionally required is that the adjective be restrictively interpreted. (Alexiadou 2014: XX)

In Alexiadou's (2014) (cf. REFERENCES) implementation polydefinites are analysed as reduced restrictive relative clauses. If so, both the restrictivity requirement and the unavailability of non-intersective adjectives immediately follow. In non-reduced restrictive relative clauses intersective adjectives are infelicitous in non-restrictive contexts, as in (8), and non-intersective adjectives, as in (9), are clearly out. The status of such examples is uncontroversial; native speakers of Greek consider them to be very clearly unacceptable and there is no apparent inter-speaker, dialectal, or other variation.

(8) Context: In room with a single book in it, which is red and lies on the table, the speaker points to the book and says to the hearer:
#Fere mu to vivlio pu ine kokino!
bring me the book that is red
'Bring me the book that is red!'

(9) *Elpizo na silavun tus tromokrates pu ine ipotithemeni.
hope.I SUBJ arrest the terrorists that are alleged
'I hope they will arrest the terrorists that are alleged.'

This type of account makes the straightforward prediction that the corresponding examples with polydefinite DPs in (10) and (11) will be equally unacceptable. More generally, the prediction is that intersective adjectives in polydefinite DPs will be as unacceptable as the example in (8) in every context in which restrictivity is not satisfied and non-intersective adjectives in polydefinite DPs will always be as unacceptable as example (9). The assumption that this prediction is borne out forms the empirical basis of the restrictivity requirement and informs the majority of syntactico-semantic analyses of Greek polydefiniteness.

[4] As can be seen in example (6), it is common practice in the relevant literature to provide judgements of mere phrases rather than sentences. Moreover, except for some examples, like, e.g., (2)-(4) above, context is very rarely specified. Our paper should be seen as a corrective against these practices. Notice also that authors (sometimes even the same author) are not consistent in using a single diacritic to indicate unavailable polydefinites. We have chosen to keep the diacritics used in the cited works.

(10) Context: In room with a single book in it, which is red and lies on the table, the speaker points to the book and says to the hearer:
Fere mu to kokino to vivlio!
bring me the red the book
'Bring me the red book!'

(11) Elpizo na silavun tus ipotithemenus tus tromokrates.
hope.I SUBJ arrest the alleged the terrorists
'I hope they will arrest the alleged terrorists.'

This paper challenges the empirical basis of the restrictivity requirement by examining in detail the status of polydefinites like the ones in (10) and (11) in various contexts. The results of two questionnaires reveal that, although in neutral, out-of-the-blue contexts the restrictive interpretation of polydefinites is indeed favoured and that non-intersective adjectives are, as a whole, less acceptable than intersective adjectives, the non-restrictive interpretation of polydefinites is much more prevalent and less strict than has been assumed so far. We show that, in principle, all polydefinites can have non-restrictive interpretations and that all adjectives, both intersective and non-intersective, can participate in polydefinite constructions. Contrasts in unacceptability of polydefinites between contexts or between adjective types do occur, but even the least acceptable cases of polydefinites are never as strongly and clearly unacceptable as examples like (8) and (9) or even as unacceptable as known violations of discourse- and information-structural requirements (we compare with infelicitous word-orders). Our findings have analytical consequences. To derive the emerging empirical picture, it is not possible to assume any hard-wired constraint of restrictivity in the syntax or semantics of polydefinites. In fact, it is not possible to assume that polydefiniteness forces any particular semantic relation between the adjective and the nominal. We provide an analysis that builds on the assumption that the semantic relation between the adjective and the noun in a polydefinite DP is the same as in the corresponding monadic definite. Our analysis is a modified version of the apposition-based analysis of Greek polydefiniteness in Lekakou and Szendrői (2012) cast in the framework of Dynamix Syntax, which provides a general and sufficiently flexible mechanism to link distinct pieces of structure without imposing any particular semantic relation between the two.

Since the syntactico-semantic analysis of Greek polydefiniteness we propose poses no restrictions on its availability by itself, it is important to consider the factors that might contribute to the different degrees of acceptability that can be observed between different contexts or adjective types. To this we turn to the pragmatic or discourse-structural properties of Greek polydefinites, an area less studied in the relevant literature. Kolliakou (2004, 273, (12)) proposes that polydefinites are subject to a Polydefiniteness Constraint, according to which "Greek polydefinites are unambiguously non-monotone anaphoric expressions: the discourse referent Y of a polydefinite is anaphoric to an antecedent discourse referent X, such that $Y \subset X$".[5] Similar intuitions are occasionally captured by describing polydefinites as 'familiar' (e.g. Panayidou 2013) or 'd-linked' (Tsiakmakis et al. 2021), notions usually defined as imposing the weaker requirement that the referent of the polydefinite DP is a member of a

[5] Kolliakou claims that the Polydefiniteness Constraint predicts the obligatory restrictive interpretation of polydefinites. We do not see how this follows. Consider, for example, (5) in a context in which the speaker has been describing his encounters with various reptiles. Since cobras are a proper subset of reptiles, (5) is predicted to be felicitous. Similar considerations apply to all cases of non-restrictive adjectives. See Lekakou and Szendrői (2012, 134) for the same conclusion.

previously mentioned set (which already follows from Kolliakou's Polydefiniteness Constraint). Tsakali (2008) (see also Alexiadou 2014) proposes that polydefinites are subject to Heim's (1982) Prominence Condition. As such they are claimed to only be able to receive their reference anaphorically and not associatively. Tsakali (2008) claims that whereas the version of (12) with the monadic definite *ton dhasimo sijrafea* 'the famous writer' is ambiguous between referring to either the writer of the book about Arthur Miller or Arthur Miller himself, in the polydefinite version *ton dhasimo to sijrafea* 'the famous writer' can only refer to Arthur Miller.

(12) O Gianis diavase ena vivlio gia ton Arthur Miller ke thelise
the John read a book about the Arthur Miller and wanted
na gnorisi [ton diasimo (ton) sigrafea]apo konta.
SUBJ meet the famous the writer from near
'John read a book about Arthur Miller and wanted to read the famous writer in person.'

Notice, however, that the Prominence Condition is too strong of a requirement. To mention just one case where it overgenerates (we provide more in section 3), it predicts the polydefinite *i mikres i gates* 'the small cats' in (4) to be infelicitous, since the preceding DP *ta zoa* 'the animals' makes available no appropriate discourse referent. In this paper we explore the discourse-structural properties of polydefinites in relation to the restrictiveness issue. Even though we agree with Kolliakou (2004) that the primary contribution of polydefiniteness is discourse-structural, we argue that current proposals are too strong and cannot capture the full range of available contexts that make polydefinites licit. We submit that prominence is the key contribution of polydefiniteness, once we adopt a sufficiently flexible approach to prominence, as the one in Von Heusinger and Schumacher (2019) in (13).

(13) Characterization of prominence for discourse pragmatics and as a structure building principle for discourse representation
Def.1: Prominence is a relational property that singles out one element from a set of elements of equal type and structure.
Def.2: Prominence status shifts in time (as discourse unfolds).
Def.3: Prominent elements are structural attractors, i.e. they serve as anchors for the larger structures they are constituents of, and they may license more operations than their competitors.

We treat polydefinites as markers of prominence, whose contribution is to signal out the entity the polydefinite refers to. Under this assumption, the restrictive interpretation is one possibility of signalling out among many. We show that this understanding of the discourse-structural contribution of polydefiniteness explains (a) the emergence of a restrictive interpretation in certain contexts, (b) differences in degree of acceptability of polydefinites between different contexts, as well as (c) some existing observations in the literature previously attributed to the Prominence Condition. Importantly, since violations of discourse-structural requirements are very context dependent and generally known to produce weaker patterns of unacceptability compared to more strictly defined grammatical violations, we gain a better understanding of why even the most unacceptable cases of polydefinites almost never amount to the same level of unacceptability as examples like (8) or (9).

The rest of the paper is structured as follows. Section 2 reports on the results of two questionnaires on the felicity of non-restrictive interpretations, one focusing on intersective adjectives and one on non-intersective adjectives. It is shown that polydefiniteness is licit in a

far wider range of contexts and with a far wider range of adjectives than previously assumed. Section 3 presents our analysis, which is built around the ideas that (a) polydefinites are appositional structures imposing no construction-specific syntax or semantics (other than that of apposition) and (b) the main contribution of polydefiniteness is to signal out prominent entities. Section 4 compares our proposal with previous accounts of Greek polydefinites. Section 5 concludes.

2. The questionnaires

As mentioned above, previous literature has claimed (a) that intersective adjectives in polydefinite DPs are illicit in non-restrictive contexts and (b) that non-intersective adjectives are illicit in polydefinite DPs. The few cases of non-restrictive uses of polydefinites that have been identified (see especially Manolessou 2000, Panagiotidis and Marinis 2011, Chatzykiriakidis 2015) have been mostly treated as peripheral, exceptional, and puzzling in most of previous literature. This section demonstrates that non-restrictive uses of polydefinites are natural and pervasive. Section 3.1 presents the results of a questionnaire which checks the status of polydefinites with intersective adjectives in contexts in which a restrictive interpretation fails.[6] Section 3.2 presents the results of a questionnaire checking the availability of polydefinites with non-intersective adjectives in some of the same environments.

2.1 Intersective adjectives

Our study involved 34 native speakers of Greek (22 women and 13 men, age range 22–56 with mean age 36.0, 17 from Northern Greece and 15 from the rest of the country). Participants were presented with one or more context sentences, followed by a sentence. They were instructed to rate how natural or appropriate each sentence sounds given the preceding context on a scale from 1 (totally infelicitous) to 10 (totally felicitous). Sentences were designed to test semantic felicitousness of polydefinites in contexts where a restrictive interpretation is not possible. As a way to acquire a benchmark for discourse-structural violations and check the attentiveness of the participants, our questionnaire included items that checked the felicity of various word orders as answers to 'What happened?' questions in out-of-the-blue contexts. As is well-known in the relevant literature, some word orders, like SVO and VSO, make good answers to such questions, while other orders, like OVS, OSV, and SOV impose particular information-structural requirements, which are not met in the contexts we tested. One such context we used is given in (30). SVO and VSO orders received mean scores of 9.9 and 9.0, respectively. The VOS order also received a high rating of 8.4. OVS, OSV, and SOV orders received mean scores of 5.8, 3.4, and 3.6, respectively.[7,8]

(30) Context: Nikos and Anna are big fans of a daily soap opera. Yesterday, when they were watching the show together, Nikos was forced to go away for a few minutes. When he returned, he asked Anna what happened while he was gone. She responded:

[6] A relevant case we checked, but is not reported here, is that of polydefinites with epithets like *eksipnos* 'smart-ass'. See the Appendix for reasons why multiple determiners with epithets should be treated as a distinct phenomenon.

[7] In a second set of similar examples, SVO, VSO, and VOS orders received mean scores of 9.3, 7.6, and 7.6 respectively, while OVS, OSV, and SOV orders received mean scores of 4.8, 3.0, and 3.5, respectively.

[8] One respondent (L1 Russian) was excluded as non-native. A Cypriot speaker is retained as a native speaker of Greek (Cypriot variety). One participant was excluded from regional analysis due to missing region. See the Appendix for more details on the questionnaire and statistical analysis.

(31) O Jagos tilefonise sti Virna. *SVO*
the Jagos called to.the Virna
'Jagos called Virna.'
(32) Tilefonise o Jagos sti Virna. *VSO*
called the Jagos to.the Virna
'Jagos called Virna.'
(33) Tilefonise sti Virna o Jagos. *VOS*
called to.the Virna the Jagos
'Jagos called Virna.'
(34) Sti Virna tilefonise o Jagos. *OVS*
to.the Virna called the Jagos
'Jagos called Virna.'
(35) Sti Virna o Jagos tilefonise. *OSV*
to.the Virna the Jagos called
'Jagos called Virna.'
(36) O Jagos sti Virna tilefonise. *SOV*
the Jagos to.the Virna called
'Jagos called Virna.'

Moving to polydefiniteness, let us start with a context in which a restrictive interpretation is indeed licensed, as in (35). The monadic version of (36) received a mean score of 6.8, while its polydefinite variant received an average score of 6.9. Although the mean scores are not as high as the scores of, e.g., (31) and (32) above, they do not seem to indicate any sort of pragmatic anomaly (compared, e.g., with the scores for (33) and (34)). This is so for both variants, as most of the literature expects.

(35) Context: Maria had six cats, four black cats and two white ones. Every time she went on a trip, a neighbour took care of the cats.
(36) I mavres (i) gates den ton simpathusan, parola afta.
the black the cats not him liked despite this.
'Nevertheless, the black cats didn't like him.'

Moving to a context which does not license a restrictive reading, as in (38), the results are comparable. Both the monadic version of (39), which received an average score of 6.8 and the its polydefinite variant, which received an average score of 7.5, are licensed, with the polydefinite version being slightly preferred. Notice that the polydefinite version should be infelicitous if the restrictive interpretation of polydefinites were a hard constraint. In fact, the polydefinite does not even respect the weak Polydefiniteness Constraint in this context, since the referent of the polydefinite DP is not a subset of any contextually prominent set of individuals.

(38) Context: Maria had six cats, all of them black. Every time she went on a trip, a neighbour took care of the cats.
(39) I mavres (i) gates den ton simpathusan, parola afta.
the black the cats not him liked despite this.
'Nevertheless, the black cats didn't like him.'

Polydefinites improve further and marginally out-perform monadic definites, in non-restrictive contexts in which the referent of the relevant nominal is contrasted with some other individual.

We checked nominals as contrastive topics, a sub-case of topic-shift. The monadic version of (42) received a mean score of 7.4, while the polydefinite version received a mean score of 7.5.

(41) Context: My aunt loves animals. She has two parrots and four small cats at home. Her parrots cause her a lot of problems.

(42) Apo tin ali meria, i mikres (i) gates den ine katholu apetitikes.
from the other side the small the cats not are at_all needy
'On the other hand, the small cats are not needy at all.'

The results are similar even when the nominal contributes new information, as in the context of (45). The nominal appears in a contrastive topic position, but its referent has not been previously introduced. The monadic version of (46) received a mean score of 7.1, while the polydefinite variant received a mean score of 7.4. Notice that, whereas the polydefinite respects the Polydefiniteness Constraint in this context, it does not respect the Prominence Condition.

(44) Context: My cousin John loves animals and has many pets. His rabbits are always calm and never cause him any trouble.

(45) Apo tin ali meria, i mavri (i) skili tu ine poli apetitiki.
from the other side the small the dogs his are very needy
'On the other hand, his black dogs are very needy.'

Polydefinites are also licensed and get scores virtual identical to those of monadic definites in what we will call 'recall'-contexts. Consider first (47), which is another case of a non-restrictive context with no contrasting individual. The monadic version of (48) received an average score of 6.7, whereas the polydefinite received an average score of 6.8. Notice that in this case the referent of the definite, while not new, is not prominent in the context of the interlocutors. Chatzikyriakidis (2015) describes such cases as instances of 'very low referent accessibility'.

(47) Context: Helen and Maria are in the desert, near the area in Egypt Helen lives. Helen has told Maria that the only vegetation within 50 kilometers consists of low shrubs. As they drive through this area with the low shrubs in their jeep, Helen says to Maria…

(48) I xamili (i) thamni ine afti edo.
the short the bushes are these here
'The short bushes are these ones here.'

Both polydefinites and monadic definites improve further in the same context if more clues are provided for identifying the intended referent. In (51) this is done via the addition of a relative clause. Both the monadic and the polydefinite versions received mean scores of 8.4. The difference between the short and long versions in (48) and (X) is the only statistically significant difference in the questionnaire.

(51) I xamili i thamni pu su elega extes to vradhi ine afti
the short the bushes that you told yesterday the night are these
edo.
here
'The short bushes I was telling you about last night are these ones here.'

Our questionnaire also confirms that cases of polydefinites with single reference like, e.g. *Lefkos Pirgos* 'White Tower' first mentioned in Manolessou (2000), are also licit. The monadic

version of (53) received an average score of 8.2. The polydefinite version received a score of 8.7. In the context of (52), *Lefkos Pirgos* 'White Tower' is a stand-in for the city of Thessaloniki and no restrictivity inference arises.

(52) Context: PAOK (a soccer club), who in the meantime was crowned champion the previous year, has won against Olympiacos (their big rivals) away from home and with three matches remaining, is in first place. Two PAOK fans in a café are discussing the upcoming championship win. One says to the other…

(53) I PAOKara tha mas feri to protathlima ston Lefko (ton) pirgo ke fetos.
the PAOK.AUGM will us bring the championship to.the white the tower and this.year
'The great PAOK will bring the trophy to the White Tower again this year.'

Consider next a case of a non-restrictive reading which has been previously described as case where the 'referent […] is directly accessible in the discourse' (Lekakou and Szendrői 2012, p. 109, fn.4, example originally from Manolessou 2000). It is not clear that the referent must indeed be directly accessible in the discourse. What seems to be more important is that sentence containing the polydefinite is part of a narrative. The monadic version of (56) received an average score of 8.2 and the polydefinite an average score of 8.0. Notice, that this is a case of a novel definite; the car has not been introduced before in the discourse, nor is there any requirement that George, the addressee, is aware of the existence of the new car, or that there are other relevant cars (i.e. that a restrictivity inference arises).

(55) Context: Eleni is explaining to George how their friend Natalia moved and changed jobs. George is curious and asks for more details. "There are no more details…"

(56) Apla ena proi, sikothike, mpike sto kenurio tis (to) aftokinito ke efige.
simply one morning wake_up entered to.the new her the car and left
'One morning, she simply woke up, got into her new car and left'

A similar example from Manolessou (2000), which we didn't include in our questionnaire, is given in (58).

(58) Vgike exo ston krio ton kero.
went-out out in.the cold the weather
'S/he went out in the cold weather.'

The table in X.X shows the results. They can be summarized as follows:[9] (a) Polydefinites can readily appear in all the contexts we tested in which a restrictive interpretation is not possible. Sentence with polydefinite DPs in such contexts received mean scores between 6.8 and 8.7; (b) Even when monadics are preferred in these contexts, the mean difference in judgments between monadics and polydefinites is small. Differences between monadic definites and polydefinites in mean scores ranged from 0.1 to 1.2 (with an average of 0.5) and were never statistically significant; (c) Polydefinites slightly outperformed monadic definites in contexts of topic shift; (d) The difference between long and short definites was statistically significant for both mono-

[9] See the appendix for a more detailed presentation of the results and the statistical analysis and a full presentation of all the stimuli used in the questionnaire.

and polydefinites; (e) We have found no evidence of such inter-speaker variation in our questionnaire. Although speakers can and do differ in the scoring of individual cases, all speakers accepted the majority of non-restrictive polydefinites, and we found no speaker that systematically rejected polydefinites in non-restrictive contexts (contra Alexiadou 2014, Lekakou and Szendrői 2012 who have suggested that the availability of non-restrictive readings is subject to inter-speaker variation); (f) We have no found no evidence of dialectal variation.

Condition	Polydefinite Mean	Monodefinite Mean	Difference Mono-Poly	Significance
Restrictive	6.88	6.77	−0.11	No
Non-Restrictive	7.50	6.82	−0.68	No
Restrictive, Contrast	7.53	7.35	−0.18	No
Restrictive, Contrast, New	7.38	7.09	−0.29	No
Recall, short	6.82	6.74	−0.08	No
Recall, long	8.35	8.44	0.09	No
Single reference	8.71	8.18	−0.53	No
Narrative	8.03	8.24	0.21	n.s.

We take these results to provide direct evidence against any analysis that imposes restrictivity as a grammatical requirement of polydefiniteness. At the same time, the results provide further evidence against both discourse-structural requirements that have been proposed in the literature. Kolliakou's (2004) Polydefiniteness Constraint is violated in all non-restrictive contexts discussed here, except for (43) and (46). These cases, on the other hand, are violations of the Prominence Condition. At the same time, the difference between short and long polydefinites supports the importance of pragmatic considerations in determining the availability of polydefiniteness.

2.2 Non-intersective adjectives

In a second questionnaire we tested the availability of polydefinite DPs with non-intersective adjectives, which are taken to be illicit in polydefinite DPs in most of the literature. We tested the privative adjective *proin* 'ex', the modal non-subsective adjective *feromenos* 'alleged', the subjective adjective *ekpliktikos* 'amazing', the ethnic adjective *Italikos* 'Italian', the adjectives *jrijoros* 'fast' and *oreos* 'beautiful' in their subsective interpretations. We also checked the adjective *dhilitiriodhis* 'poisonous' as a modifier of *kombres* 'cobras', in which case it can only receive a non-restrictive interpretation.[10] For simplicity we refer to all the cases we checked here as cases of polydefinites with non-restrictive adjectives. All such cases have been argued to be infelicitous in previous literature (see Alexiadou (2014) for an overview).

Our study involved 18 native speakers of Greek (9 women and 10 men, age range 38–55 with mean 44.8, 11 from Northern Greece and 7 from the rest of the country). As in the first questionnaire, participants were presented with one or more context sentences, followed by a target sentence. They were instructed to rate how natural or appropriate the sentence sounds

[10] As in the first questionnaire, we also tested different word-order variations with results similar to those in the first questionnaire. SVO, VSO, and VOS orders, whose information-structural requirements are met in context, received mean scores of 9.9, 8.9, and 8.2 respectively, while OVS, OSV, and SOV orders, whose information-structural requirements are not met in context, received mean scores of 5.2, 3.6, and 4.2, respectively.

given the preceding context on a scale from 1 (totally infelicitous) to 10 (totally felicitous). Sentences were designed to test semantic felicitousness of polydefinites with non-restrictive adjectives in two types of contexts: contexts of contrast and recall contexts (with a long definite). Contexts of contrast have been identified in previous literature as licensing at least some non-intersective polydefinites. For example, Lekakou and Szendrői (2012) point out that (X) is acceptable if the Dutch invasion is contrasted with some other invasion. Leu (2008) claims that (X), with the privative adjective *proijumenos* 'previous', is acceptable if the previous prime minister is contrasted with some other prime minister. Recall contexts were contexts in which non-restrictive intersective adjectives performed particularly well in the previous questionnaire.[11]

(X) I olandiki i isvoli mas kseklirise.
the Dutch the invasion us wiped.out
'The Dutch invasion wiped us out.'

(X) O PROIJUMENOS o prothipurjos pethane.
the previous the prime-minister died
'It is the previous prime minister that died.'

For illustration, we will present here the relevant data from two non-intersective cases, the adjective *feromenos* 'alleged', which received the lowest ratings in polydefinites in our investigation, and the adjective *jrijoros* 'fast' in its subsective interpretation, which received the highest ratings. Consider first *feromenos* 'alleged'. In the contrastive context in (X), the polydefinite version of (X) received a mean rating of 4.9, while the monodefinite version received a mean rating of 8.8. In the recall context of (X), the polydefinite version of (X) receives a mean rating of 6.0 and the monodefinite version a mean rating of 9.2.[12]

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[11] Lekakou and Szendrői (2012) (see also Alexiadou 2014) claims that in (X) and all cases of felicitous non-intersective adjectives in polydefinites the adjective is coerced to behave like a restrictive modifier. However, the example in (X) retains all the properties of privative predication. Specifically, it entails neither that the deceased individual is now a prime minister nor that it is or was 'previous'. Similar considerations apply to all felicitous cases reported in this section; the non-intersective adjectives retain their non-intersective semantics in polydefinites. It is thus not clear what 'coercion to a restrictive interpretation' of the adjective would amount to. Notice that a coercion-based account would furthermore have to explain why coercion can license non-intersective adjectives in polydefinites, but not in simple predications like, e.g., (i).

(i) *O apothanon itan proijumenos.
the deceased was previous
'The deceased was previous.'

[12] It is worth pointing out that polydefinite versions of *feromenos dhrastis* 'alleged perpetrator' appear very regularly in news reports like, e.g., (ii) (To Vima newspaper, news report of 05/03/2022, accessed at https://tinyurl.com/59bjmf9f) with no implication that the alleged perpetrator is an actual perpetrator.

(ii) Sta xeria tis astinomias vriskete o feromenos o drastis tu
in.the hands the police is the alleged the perpetrator the
protofanus eglimatos pu stixiseti zoise mana, patera
unprecedented crime REL cost the life to mother father
ke dhio mora stin Andravida
and two babies in.the Adravida
'The alleged perpetrator of the unprecedent crime that cost the lives of a mother, a father, and two babies in Adravida is in police custody.'

(X) Context: Mirsini, a journalist in a major newspaper, is talking with her editor. They are trying to decide which of two pictures should go on tomorrow's front page. The first picture depicts the perpetrator of a crime who was just convicted to ten years in jail. The second picture depicts the son of minister who is accused of embezzlement of public funds. Mirisini says to the editor…

(X) O feromenos (o) dhrastis tu dhefteru eglimatos tha
the alleged the perpetrator the.GEN second.GEN crime.GEN will
pulisi perisotera fila.
sell more papers
'The alleged perpetrator of the second crime will sell more papers.'

(X) Context: Mirsini, a journalist in a major newspaper, is investigating a scandal involving embezzlement of public funds. On Monday she is telling her editor everything known about the alleged perpetrator. The next day she tells her editor…

(X) O feromenos (o) dhrastis pu su eleja extes omolojise.
the alleged the perpetrator that you told yesterday confessed
'The alleged perpetrator I was talking to you about yesterday confessed.'

Consider next the adjective *jrijoros* 'fast' in its subsective interpretation. In the contrastive context in (X), the polydefinite version of (X) received a mean rating of 7.7, while the monodefinite version received a mean rating of 9.6. In the recall context of (X), the polydefinite version of (X) receives a mean rating of 8.9 and the monodefinite version a mean rating of 9.3.

(X) Context: Kostas and Anna are attending a talk at an academic conference. The talk is delivered by two scientists; one of the two speaks very fast and the other one very slow. At the end of the talk, Kostas tells Anna…

(X) O jrijoros (o) omilitis dulevi sto Aristotelio
the fast the speakers works at.the Aristotle
'The fast speaker works at the Aristotle University.'

(X) Context: Kostas came on Sunday after attending a conference. At the conference he was very impressed by a speaker who spoke very fast. On Monday at work he spent half an hour telling his colleague Anna all about that speaker. The next day Kostas tells Anna…

(X) O jrijoros (o) omilitis pu su eleja extes dulevi sto Aristotelio
the fast the speakers that you told yesterday works at.the Aristotle
'The fast speaker I was talking to you about yesterday works at the Aristotle University.'

Table X.X below presents the results for non-intersective adjectives.[13] The results can be summarized as follows: (a) the polydefinite versions consistently score significantly lower than the corresponding monodefinite versions, with the exception of *oreos* 'beautiful', (b) with the sole exception of *proin* 'ex' in the contrast condition, which scores 4.9, the polydefinite versions always receive ratings above the midpoint with a range of mean ratings from 4.9 to 8.9, (c) although the polydefinite versions consistently show numerically higher ratings in recall contexts the difference between recall and contrast contexts is significant in only a few cases (*proin* 'ex', *oreos* 'beautiful'), (d) although there is more inter-speaker variation in the ratings of individual cases (compared to the first questionnaire), there is no speakers who consistently rejects non-intersective adjectives in polydefinites and no speaker who

[13] See the appendix for a more detailed presentation of the results and the statistical analysis and a full presentation of all the stimuli used in the questionnaire.

consistently rejects non-intersective adjectives in any particular context, (e) we have found no evidence of dialectal variation.

Condition	Polydefinite Mean	Monodefinite Mean	Difference	Significance
proin 'ex' (contrast)	5.39	9.33	−3.94	**Yes*** **
proin 'ex' (recall)	7.22	9.56	−2.34	**Yes** **
Italikos 'Italian' (contrast)	7.06	8.72	−1.66	**Yes***
Italikos 'Italian' (recall)	7.44	9.95	−2.55	
ekpliktikos 'amazing' (contrast)	6.78	9.33	−2.55	**Yes** **
ekpliktikos 'amazing' (recall)	7.28	9.56	−2.28	**Yes** **
feromenos 'alleged' (contrast)	4.89	8.78	−3.89	**Yes*** **
feromenos 'alleged' (recall)	6.00	9.22	−3.22	**Yes*** **
dhilitiriodhis 'poisonous' (recall)	7.72	9.56	−1.84	**Yes** **
jrijoros 'fast' (contrast)	7.72	9.61	−1.89	**Yes** **
jrijoros 'fast' (recall)	8.94	9.33	−0.39	No (n.s.)
oreos 'beautiful' (contrast)	7.94	7.44	0.951	No (n.s.)
oreos 'beautiful' (recall)	8.83	8.89	0.06	No (n.s.)

We take these results to provide further evidence against the restrictivity requirement as a grammatical requirement of polydefiniteness; there is no link between (non-)intersectivity and (non-)restrictivity relevant to the grammar of polydefiniteness. All existing accounts predict non-intersective adjectives to be ungrammatical since they treat polydefinites as DP-internal predicational structures of some sort or other, where the predicational relation is interpreted intersectively.[14] Alexiadou and Wilder (1998), Alexiadou (2007, 2014), Panayidou (2013), a.o. analyze polydefinites as reduced restrictive relative clauses, so that non-restrictive interpretations are excluded across the board. As pointed out in Panagiotidis and Marinis (2011), although DP-internal predication predicts non-intersective adjectives to be infelicitous in polydefinites, it does not, by itself, exclude intersective adjectives from receiving non-restrictive interpretations in polydefinites. As seen in the discussion of the first questionnaire Panagiotidis and Marinis (2011) (cf. Manolessou 2000) claim that this is an advantage and argue that such cases do exist, as we have also confirmed. At the same time, their accounts make the wrong prediction for non-intersective adjectives.

Notice that the problem persists even for existing accounts that are intended to allow non-restrictive polydefinites. Tsiakmakis et al. (2021) experimentally investigated the distribution of adjectives in polydefinites. Next to five intersective adjectives, they included five non-intersective adjectives (*feromenos* 'alleged', *ipotithemenos* 'supposed', *proin* 'former', *elinikos* 'Greek', *ekpliktikos* 'amazing'.) Tsiakmakis et al. (2021) reports that, although the five non-intersective adjectives are less accepted than the intersective ones, non-intersective adjectives still receive a mean acceptability rating of >30% in a 0 to 100 scale.[15] They propose a version of Alexiadou and Wilder (1998), Alexiadou (2014) in treating polydefinites as reduced relative clauses. Unlike these works, however, Tsiakmakis et al. (2021) allows polydefinites to be formed on either restrictive or non-restrictive relative clauses. This latter option is claimed to

[14] All the non-intersective adjectives we have checked, with the exception of *ekpliktikos* 'amazing' are non-predicational.
[15] Tsiakmakis et al. (2021) uses the minimal context of *wh*-questions.

be responsible for the availability of polydefiniteness with non-intersective adjectives. They exemplify this latter option with the adjective *ekpliktikos* 'amazing', which is predicational and can appear in non-restrictive relative clauses, as shown in (28). They make no mention of how the rest of non-restrictive adjectives are to be handled. As we have mentioned, privative and ethnic adjectives are not predicational and, as such, cannot appear in non-restrictive relative clauses. We exemplify with *feromenos* 'alleged' in (29), but the same is true for the rest of the non-restrictive adjectives they check.[16]

(28) I parastasi, i opia ine ekpliktiki, tha stamatisi tin Paraskevi.
the show the who is amazing FUT stop the Friday
'The show, which is amazing, will stop on Friday.'

(29) *O dhrastis, o opios ine feromenos, sinelifthi tin Paraskevi.
the perpetrator the who is alleged was.arrested the Friday
'The perpetrator, who is alleged, was arrested on Friday.'

We conclude that no existing account is compatible with the empirical generalizations that emerge from our investigation. This is understandable since previous approaches were developed to deal with a different empirical picture in which polydefinites necessarily involve a restrictive interpretation. Our investigation demonstrates that cases of non-restrictive polydefinites represent robust and productive patterns that any comprehensive analysis must account for. In the following section we present an analysis of the syntax-semantics of polydefiniteness that does not impose any specific semantic requirement on polydefinites.

3. The syntax-semantics of polydefiniteness

In this section we present our proposal about the morpho-syntax polydefiniteness. We propose an analysis of the morpho-syntax of polydefinites which rests on the assumption that their truth-conditional contribution is identical to that of the corresponding monadic definites. The analysis is a revision of the Lekakou and Szendrői (2012) apposition-based analysis, cast in the framework of Dynamic Syntax (Kempson et al. 2001, Cann et al. 2005, cf. Chatzikyriakidis 2015 for Greek polydefinites in Dynamic Syntax). Section 3.1 presents the basic idea behind an apposition-based analysis. Section 3.2 briefly presents the basic ideas behind Dynamic Syntax. Section 3.3 presents our version of an apposition-based analysis. Finally, in section 3.4 we briefly compare our analysis with the apposition-based analysis of Lekakou and Szendrői (2012).

3.1 A revised apposition-based analysis

Given the empirical findings reported in section 2, any analysis of polydefiniteness should capture (a) the fact that all types of adjectives are in principle licit in the construction and (b) that polydefiniteness imposes no necessary connection to (non-)restrictivity. We do not see how to revise predication-based accounts without running into an under-generation problem. We propose, instead, a version of an apposition-based account (Lekakou and Szendrői 2012, Chatzikyriakidis 2015). Lekakou and Szendrői (2012) first treats polydefiniteness as close apposition involving an adjective and a nominal, akin to nominal apposition which involves two nominals, as in (12).

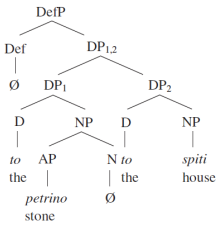
[16] Lekakou and Szendrői (2012) argue for a non-predicational account of polydefinites which, however, still adopts the restrictivity requirement. Since this account is the one closest to our own proposal we discuss it separately in section 3.4.

(12) o aetos to puli
the eagle the bird

The crucial property of (12) is that it involves a complex DP containing two phrases of the same type (here DPs) combined via complex argument formation, i.e. (12) refers to a single entity, an eagle. Lekakou and Szendrői (2012) argues that, similarly, polydefiniteness involves complex argument formation, where one DP involves nominal ellipsis and the other does not, as in (13b) for the DP in (13a). Complex argument formation is based on the rule of R(eferential)-role Identification. R-role Identification identifies the referential roles (i.e. the external theta-roles) of the two DPs. According to Higginbotham (1985), this R-role identification semantically corresponds to set intersection. This, of course, can only work if the two DPs actually denote predicates of type *e,t*. Lekakou and Szendrői (2012) argues that this is indeed the case since the two overt determiners are expletive and that definiteness is only contributed at the top level by a covert *Def* head.[17]

(13) a. to megalo to spiti
the big the house
'the big house'

b.



By adopting set-intersection as an obligatory component of the semantics of apposition, Lekakou and Szendrői (2012)'s proposal is designed to exclude non-restrictive intersective adjectives and non-intersective adjectives from polydefiniteness. It thus needs to be revised. In the next two sections we propose such a revision cast in the framework of Dynamic Syntax and return to Lekakou and Szendrői (2012) in section 3.4.

3.2 Dynamic Syntax

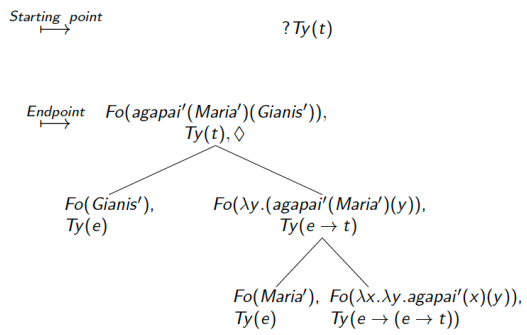
Dynamic Syntax (DS) (Kempson et al. 2001; Cann et al. 2005) is a processing-oriented framework. According to DS natural language syntax can be seen as the progressive accumulation of transparent semantic representations with the upper goal being the

[17] Most of the literature assumes that a single definite in a polydefinite DP contributes semantically. In a rare exception, Etxeberria and Giannakidou (2018) treat additional definite determiners as contributing a contextually valued domain restriction *C*. This is claimed to generate a restrictive interpretation (or 'partitive' as described in that paper). So, a DP like *to megalo to spiti* 'the big house' will receive the interpretation in (i) (cf. Etxeberria and Giannakidou 2018, p.23, (50)). We use the paper's notation. We do not see how adding a domain restriction generates a restrictive or partitive interpretation, since the presence of *C* does not by itself impose any requirements on the relation between *N* and *A* and no restrictions on the interpretation of *C* are proposed.

(i) ι(λx(house(x))∩C(x)∩big(x))

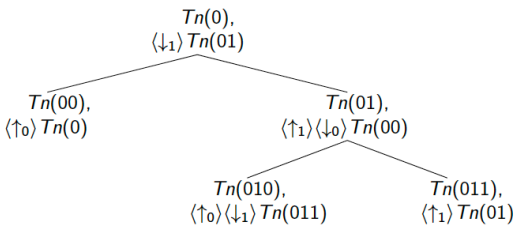
construction of a logical propositional formula (a formula of type *t*). This process is driven by monotonic tree growth, representing the attempt to model the way information is processed in a time- linear, incremental, word-to-word manner. DS is goal driven, generally driven by means of requirements (requirements are represented by the question mark *?*). A well-formed sentence is one where all nodes have a formula (semantic content) and a type (semantic type) value and no outstanding requirements exist. Reaching this well-formed structure requires a sequence of partial-tree updates. This updating allows the transition from a sole requirement for a proposition to a complete tree. The example below shows the starting point and the end result of parsing *o Giorgos agapai ti Maria* 'George loves Mary'.

(69) Beginning and end of a complete parse in DS



A tree is well-formed if and only if no outstanding requirements remain. A string is then said to be grammatical if and only if there exists a tree-update that leads to a well-formed structure. In the above example, all nodes have formula (Fo) and type (Ty) values. The ◇ sign is called the pointer and represents the place in the tree where the parsing process is at a given point. The whole system is underpinned by the Logic of Finite Trees (Blackburn and Meyer-Viol 1994), a modal logic to talk about trees. LOFT uses two basic arrow relations ↓ and ↑, corresponding to the daughter and mother relation respectively. Left nodes are addressed as 0 nodes, whereas right nodes as 1 nodes. Conventionally, nodes on the left correspond to the argument nodes, i.e. the nodes in which the arguments will be represented, whereas the 1 nodes correspond to the functor nodes, i.e. the nodes in which all the various types of predicates will be represented. The rootnode, defined as the sole node that does not have a mother node, is given the treenode address 0. The example below illustrates the flexibility of LOFT by showing a binary tree where different nodes are addressed from the perspective of other nodes using treenode relations.

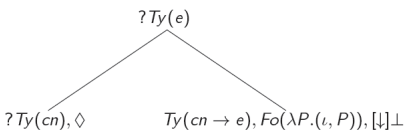
(70) The LOFT language in action



The procedural part of the framework consists of (a) lexical and (b) computational actions. The former are lexical information stored in an algorithmic format that contain various kinds of information, in effect the lexical entries for individual words. Computational rules on the other hand are general rules that facilitate the parsing process. These include rules for pointer movement, rules for functional application, rules that get rid of requirements etc.

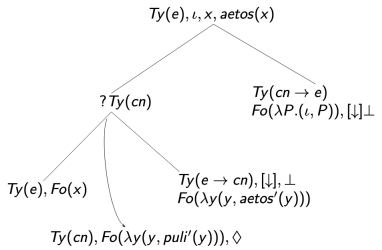
The most important mechanism for the account of polydefinites that we are going to sketch in this paper is that of LINKed structures. These constitute a formal pairing of one tree to another through the presence of a shared term in each tree. The node from which the link starts can be seen as setting the context in which the linked tree is parsed. Examples of constructions that are explained using the link mechanism include relative clauses, in which case the relative clause is parsed within the context of the head noun, topic structures, like, e.g., Hanging Topic Left Dislocation (HTLD) constructions in which case the HTLD sentence is parsed against the backdrop of the left-dislocated element, and conditional clauses, where the antecedent sets the context. LINK mechanisms have also been assumed to be behind appositional structures (Gregoromichelaki et al., 2009). Let us see the case of o *aetos to puli* 'the eagle the bird'. We are in a type *e* requiring node, i.e. a node that needs a semantic formula of type *e*. This is the trigger for the definite determiner. After parsing the definite determiner, we get the structure in (71).

(71) Parsing the definite determiner



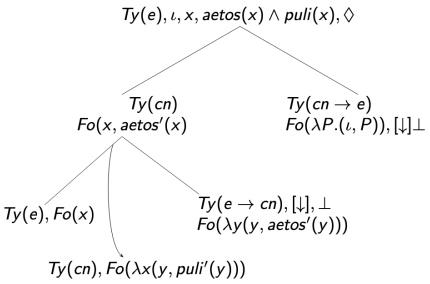
The quantificational force of the definite is added, as well as a node requiring a *cn* noun type (a special type, which can be seen as a shorthand for e → t). The pointer (diamond), which shows the point where the parse is at a given point is left on that node. The first NP is parsed and adds the internal *e* node and the restrictor. We assume that the role of the second definite is to initiate a LINK relation from the type *?cn* node to a type *?cn* node. In effect the role of the second definite is procedural and not semantic, facilitating the LINK process, rather than contributing to the truth-conditions. Once in the LINKed tree, the second NP is parsed, eventually producing the formula in (72). Compilation of the main tree results in:

(72) Parsing close appositions, LINK relation



Now, a LINK evaluation rule is used in order to decide the relation between the two semantic trees. In the case of close apposition, the LINK relation is initiated from the ?cn node. Two nominal predicates are linked, and LINK evaluation applies conjunction to combine them. Note that LINK evaluation rules are a family of rules that have to do with evaluating the semantics of two LINKed trees, they are not restricted to conjunction by any means. In other words, LINK evaluation decides the way two LINKed structures are going to be put together semantically. The end result is given in (73). Both nominal predicates contribute their semantic content, which are then conjoined through LINK evaluation.

(73) Parsing close appositions, LINK evaluation



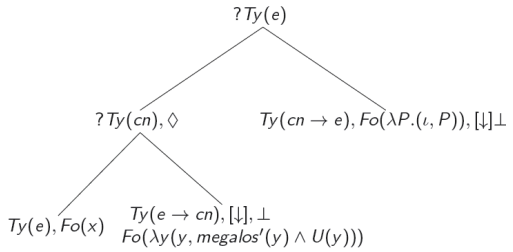
3.3 Polydefinites and monadic definites in Dynamic Syntax

We propose to treat polydefinites as involving of LINK structures (cf. Chatzikyriakidis 2015). In the case of polydefinites, the first definite article creates a normal quantificational definite structure. When the adjective is parsed, it creates a predicate that projects a metavariable representing the noun that will later on will substitute this metavariavble with a proper nominal predicate value. As in the case of close appositions, when the second definite article comes into parse, it triggers a LINK relation from the ?cn node to a ?cn node. Crucially, close appositions also initiate LINK from the ?cn node, but in that case two nominal predicates are evaluated via conjunction through LINK evaluation. In polydefinites, by contrast, an adjectival predicate, which is standardly assumed in DS to contain a metavariable U (e.g. big(x) $\wedge$ U(x)) (Chatzikyriakidis 2015, 2025), is linked with a nominal predicate, and LINK evaluation performs unification rather than conjunction (U is substituted for *anthropos* 'human' in the case of *o megalos o anthropos* 'the big man'), in effect without forcing any particular semantic relationship (like restrictiveness). This strategy explains the identical truth conditions to

monadic definites (same semantic result) while, at the same time, allows all adjective types (no built-in constraints) and both restrictive/non-restrictive interpretations.

Let us see now how polydefinites and monadic definites work in Dynamic Syntax.[18] As in close apposition, we start in a type *e* requiring node and the first definite is parsed adding its quantificational force. Now, the adjective comes into parse, which results in the following (let us assume parse of *o megalos o anthropos* 'the big human') in (75).

(75) Parsing *o megalos* in *o megalos o anthropos* "the big human"



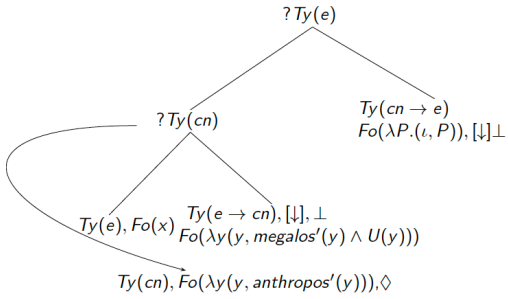
The adjective introduces its semantics, which, in this example, happen to be intersective and leaves a metavariable in the formula which will correspond to the class denoted by the noun (U(y)), plus a fresh variable x (Fo(x)) of type *e*.[19] In the case of monadics, the noun will follow, will provide that substitution, e.g. *Human(y)* and composition will follow via modus ponens for types and functional application for formulas. In polydefinites, like close appositions, the second definite initiates a LINK from the type ?*cn* node is to another type ?*cn* node.[20] As we have mentioned, we assume this link to be the result of parsing the second definite. Then the noun is parsed on that LINKed node, as in (76).

(76) Parsing *o anthropos in o megalos o anthropos,* "the big human"

[18] As already said, Lekakou and Szendrői assign referential roles to both the elided noun and the overt noun. However, this R1 in the case of the elided noun cannot be given before some pragmatic substitution of the relevant noun is made. In our case, this substitution can actually happen when the overt noun appears. In this sense, there is no R-role identification but rather substitution of an R role metavariable with the value of the overt noun.

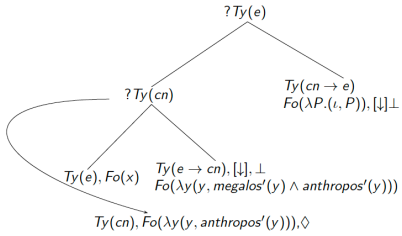
[19] Modification in Dynamic Syntax has not received extensive discussion but there are however a number of approaches regarding aspects of adjectival and adverbial modification. For example, Seraku & Ohtani (2016), attributive adjectives are treated in the same sense as relative clauses (i.e. as LINK structures) and Chatzikyriakidis (2017) that assumes both strategies (non-LINK and LINK) to be possible. Similarly, Chatzikyriakidis (2017) proposes that adverbials involve LINK relations from the propositional or the predicate node, depending on the type of adverbial.

[20] Note that in this case, we differ from Chatzikyriakidis (2015), who assumes that the LINK relation is initiated from the internal type *e* node to another type *e* node. The account as put forth by Chatzikyriakidis, assumes that the second definite is not devoid of content, but contributes the same definite semantics in that second tree, something that we do not posit here.



An evaluation rule unifies the formula value of the LINKed node with that of the type e → cn node, in this specific case substituting the metavariable U with *anthropos*. The result is given in (77).[21]

(77) LINK evaluation



Let us once again stress that close appositions use the same LINK structure from the *?cn* node to a *?cn* node, but link two noun semantics (N_1 and N_2) which are then conjoined via LINK evaluation, whereas polydefinites link adjective semantics containing a metavariable with noun semantics, with unification rather than conjunction.[22]

As we have already said, there is nothing in this account that forces an intersective interpretation of adjectives or anything that will preclude any other non-intersective adjective to appear. All we need to assume is that all adjectives contain a meta-variable U. For example, assume some simplistic semantics of an adjective like *alleged: λy(y, ∃x(Human(x) ∧ Claims(x, U(y)))*. In this case as well, parsing of a noun like *eglimatias* 'criminal', will result in the following semantics after unification: *∃x(Human(x) ∧ Claims(x, criminal(y)))*. In any case and abstracting away of the complexities of giving semantics of adjectives, the account predicts that all adjectives that can appear with monadics are also possible with polydefinites. In effect, both monadics and polydefinites result in the exact same semantics, the only difference being the extra pragmatic constraint imposed by polydefinites, discussed in the next section. In effect,

[21] Notice that ordering freedom with polydefinites is predicted under this account. In case the noun comes first, it will first project its semantics on the type e → cn node. Then the second definite will create a LINK relation from the type ?*cn* node to a type *?cn* node where the adjective will project its semantics, as in (78).

[22] Notice also that our account predicts multiple possible applications of the LINK rule, thus multiple adjectives are predicted to be fine with polydefinites.

we treat polydefinites as appositional structures that share the LINK initiation point with close appositions (the ?cn node), but differ in the semantic content being linked and the LINK evaluation rule applied: close appositions link two nominal predicates via conjunction, while polydefinites link an adjectival predicate containing a metavariable with a nominal predicate via unification.

3.4 A short comparison with Lekakou and Szendrői (2012)

People not familiar with the framework will probably ask why move to such a framework. There are we believe at least three reasons. First, DS models incremental, word-by-word processing, something which is crucial for capturing how the second definite article triggers structural changes. Secondly, DS excels at extra-sentential and discourse phenomena, including dialogue and topic constructions that are also very crucial in case one want s to extent this present account to take into consideration these phenomena w.r.t polydefinites into account. Thirdly, and most importantly for our purposes, DS provides a general LINK mechanism that unifies the treatment close appositions and polydefinites by retaining the flexibility to denote their individual interpretative differences.

The same goes, of course, for accounts like Lekakou and Szendrői (2012), but there, R-role identification forces intersective semantics, which as we have seen, undergenerates with respect to the data. Our account does not. In effect, polydefinites, like appositional structures, involve LINKed structures.
Since Lekakou and Szendrői (2012) adopt the restrictivity requirement, their analysis is force intersective semantics onto the appositional structure to derive the alleged restriction to intersective adjectives and assume the 'Ban on vacuous application of R-role identification' in order to derive obligatorily restrictive interpretations. Both these aspects of that analysis have to be dropped. As discussed in section 2, a successful revision of Lekakou and Szendröi's (2012) analysis will also have to drop the assumption that the elided noun is resolved to a generic 'entity'-denoting nominal. Instead, the value of the elided noun will be equated to the meaning of the antecedent noun. We provide an analysis that revises Lekakou and Szendröi's (2012) proposal along these lines. However, instead of simply tweaking with the analysis in Lekakou and Szendröi (2012), we have chosen to frame our revision within a different framework, that of Dynamic Syntax (Kempson et al. 2001, Cann et al. 2005). Dynamic Syntax is a natural choice for the case at hand, because it can provide us with a general and flexible mechanism to deal with apposition and can subsume the phenomenon of polydefiniteness under a more general phenomenon of linking distinct structures.[23] Section 4.1.1 provides some relevant background on Dynamic Syntax. Section 4.1.2 then provides our analysis of polydefiniteness within that framework.

4.1 Prominence

We have argued that the meaning of a polydefinite DP is identical to that of the corresponding monadic definite. What then is the contribution of polydefiniteness, if any? As mentioned above, some authors have suggested that (next to, in their view, a restrictivity requirement)

[23] This is not to say that the analysis cannot be cast in other frameworks (as long as the key issues identified above are taken into account). We are not attempting to make an argument in favor or against specific frameworks here.

polydefinite DPs are subject to discourse structural requirements, like familiarity, salience, or prominence. We have seen, however, that existing proposals like Kolliakou's Polydefiniteness Constraint or the Prominence Condition in Tsakali (2008) and Alexiadou (2014) are too strong and undergenerate felicitous uses of polydefinites. We argue in this section that saliency and prominence, properly conceptualized, are indeed at play in these constructions. However, they are not conditions that have to be independently met for polydefinites to be felicitous, i.e. they are not conditions on the referent of the polydefinite DP. Instead, we argue that polydefinites themselves are prominence markers; i.e. grammatical devices that rank the referent of a polydefinite DP as the most prominent element among relative alternatives at that point of discourse. To do so we adopt the account of prominence given in Von Heusinger and Schumacher (2019). In doing so we can show that the restrictive interpretation is just a by-product of prominence marking under certain conditions and can explain the various cases of non-restrictive interpretations shown earlier. We thus provide a unified explanation of restrictive and non-restrictive readings of polydefinites.

Von Heusinger and Schumacher (2019) (based on Himmelmann and Primus 2015, Jasinskaja et al. 2015) adopt the following characterization of prominence for discourse pragmatics. We propose that all three definitional properties of prominence in Von Heusinger and Schumacher (2019) are crucial to understanding the contribution of polydefiniteness.

(79) Characterization of prominence for discourse pragmatics and as a structure building principle for discourse representation
Def.1: Prominence is a relational property that singles out one element from a set of elements of equal type and structure.
Def.2: Prominence status shifts in time (as discourse unfolds).
Def.3: Prominent elements are structural attractors, i.e. they serve as anchors for the larger structures they are constituents of, and they may license more operations than their competitors.

Def.1 reflects one of the basic intuitions behind current accounts of polydefinites (discussed in section 2) i.e. that felicitous use of polydefiniteness relates to some notion of contrast or the availability of alternatives. We propose that polydefiniteness has the effect of singling out the referent of the DP among a set of alternatives. Def.2 is a prerequisite for this understanding of polydefiniteness; as a definite DP, a polydefinite DP refers to a familiar entity already part of the context and the function of polydefiniteness is to change its prominence status from less prominent to most prominent. Def.3 helps us understand the multiple, varying, and sometimes subtle effects that polydefiniteness can give rise to, since prominence can result in various different types of effects. This will help us explain the licensing environments of polydefiniteness discussed in the previous two sections.

Before moving to a discussion of the data vis-à-vis prominence, let us be a bit more precise about our understanding of prominence marking. We adopt the view (based on Centering Theory, Bittner 2014 a.o., Stojnić et al. 2017 for a recent formalization) that relations of relative prominence can be formalized as a list; i.e. a sequence of individuals ranked by prominence. The first individual in the list is the most prominent one. The list changes as new individuals are introduced in the course of a discourse and grammatical mechanisms can have the effect of altering the list in a dynamic fashion. We assume a context Γ that contains discourse referents among other things and progressively adds referents as discourse unfolds. A relevant list L_{rel} keeps track of the relevant referents and adds and removes referents that are not relevant accordingly. An operator P_{ord} of type *list e* → *list e* takes a list and returns the same list ranked

according to prominence. We then assume L_{pr} to be $P_{ord}(L_{rel})$. Polydefiniteness imposes an extra pragmatic condition that the referent *x* of the DP has to be the head in the prominence list L_{pr}. If this condition is not met, then *x* is made the first element in the list (done by the $make_{fst}$ function).

(80) $fst(L_{pr}) \neq x \rightarrow make_{fst}(x)(L_{pr})$[24]

Commented [A1]: ADD FOOTNOTE ABOUT PROMINENCE AND LINK. IN GENERAL WHERE DOES THE PROMINENCE RULE COME IN

Let us first discuss how this proposal derives the primacy of restrictive interpretations of polydefinites. In the above we emphasized the fact that the notion of prominence we adopt here is a relational notion; polydefiniteness as prominence marking will only produce a new discourse structure (i.e. a new L_{pr}) if the referent of the polydefinite DP is less or equally prominent as some alternative individual. Polydefiniteness, then, has the effect of ranking the referent relative to those other individuals. What other individuals? In a normal discourse the other individuals, i.e. the other members of L_{pr}, have previously been introduced. However, when hearers are confronted with a polydefinite outside of any context (or in a very minimal, impoverished context), hearers will assume the existence of alternative individuals in order to give content to the speaker's choice to use a polydefinite DP. Crucially, if the DP is taken to receive a restrictive interpretation (which is actually the default, most prominent interpretation of monadic definite DPs to begin with) the work of constructing a set of relevant alternatives is truly minimal. Given that the restrictive interpretation by itself implies the existence of alternative individuals in the context (*N*s that are not *A*s), polydefiniteness is taken to rank the referent of the DP relative to those other individuals. We propose that this is the reason behind the prominence of restrictive interpretations with polydefinites and the corresponding analytical proposals to make restrictivity a grammatical consequence of polydefiniteness, in a literature that to the most part only considers polydefiniteness outside of context. Our proposal thus explains why polydefiniteness favors a restrictive interpretation in out-of-the-blue contexts like, e.g, (2) and (4), and why making the relevant alternatives (the *N*s that are not *A*s) overt improves the felicity of polydefiniteness in cases that have previously been taken to not allow it, like the subsective (and restrictive) adjectives *jrijoros* 'fast' and *orea* 'beautiful' in (20) and (23).

Crucially, our account does not restrict the relevant alternative individuals to *N*s that are not *A*s. In cases where a restrictive interpretation is not licensed, either because the restrictivity inference is not supported in context or because the adjective is necessarily non-restrictive, the referent of the polydefinite DP will be ranked relative to other individuals. The difference with restrictive interpretations, is that in out-of-the-blue contexts, the relevant alternatives cannot be provided by the meaning of the sentence itself. Hearers will thus have to construct a relatively rich discourse structure themselves in order to justify/ understand the use of polydefiniteness. This is not impossible to do, as we have seen in cases like (16) and (27) with the privative adjective *proin* 'former' and *feromenos* 'alleged', or with the intersective adjective *mavres* 'black' in the non-restrictive context of (38). But as we have seen in section 3, polydefinites improve and, in some cases, come to outperform monadic definites, when the alternative individuals have already been introduced in the context. This is the case with, e.g., the functional adjective *alos* 'other', whose meaning requires an alternative *N* that is *A* in context,

[24] A reviewer asks how does the syntactic account proposed derive the prominence semantics. We do not believe that the prominence semantics have to be encoded in the account. We believe that the account has to be flexible enough to allow polydefinite constructions with both restrictive and non-restrictive adjectives. One could very well encode these semantics as part of the LINK evaluation rule, but we do not believe that this prominence rule has to be hard-coded in the syntax/semantics component.

as seen in (26), or in cases of topic-shift, as in (43) and (46). As is well-known, prominence and topicality feed each other; prominent entities are more likely to be topics in subsequent utterances and topics, especially when expressed with topic-marking constructions like topicalization, clefts and topic-markers, are assigned higher prominence status (see, e.g. Ciriacescu and von Heusinger 2010, Hung and Schumacher 2012, 2014, a.o.). We take topicality to be one of the main operations that are licensed via prominence, as per Def.3 above. Prominence and topicality seem to be what drives the use of polydefiniteness in low accessibility 'recall' contexts too, as in (49) and (51). Since the speaker intends to make an individual with low accessibility the topic of their utterance, they maximize their means to make the individual available and prominent. This drives the use of additional modifiers and polydefiniteness. In (54), the case of a DP with a single reference, the monument is used as a stand-in for the city of Thessaloniki. The relevant alternatives are other cities whose teams could have won the trophy. Polydefiniteness emphasizes the fact that the trophy came to the native city of the fans. The city is, thus, the topic of the utterance, as emphasized by prominence.

Independent evidence for the claim that prominence via polydefiniteness feeds topicality comes from the fact that topic-marking structures like Clitic Left Dislocation and clefts in Greek favour polydefiniteness. We exemplify with both an intersective (and preferably restrictive) modifier in (81) and a non-restrictive modifier in (82).[25]

(81) a. Tis mavres ?(tis) jates tis taise extes o gitonas.
the black the cats them fed yesterday the neighbour.
'The neighbour fed the black cats yesterday.'
b. Itan i mavres ?(i) jates pu efagan perisotero extes.
were the black the cats that ate more yesterday
'It was the black cats that ate more yesterday.'

(82) a. Aftes tis dilitiriodis ? (tis) kobres na min tis ksana-anaferis.
these the venomous the cobras SUBJ not them again-mention.
'Do not mention these venomous cobras again.'
b. Itan i dilitiriodhis?(i) kobres pu me apetrepsan apo to na
were the venomous the cobras that me prevented from the SUBJ
taksidhepsi stin India.
travel to.the India
'It was the venomous cobras that prevented him from travelling to India.'

Notice that in (82), where the adjectival modification is non-restrictive (given the fact that all cobras are venomous), the information provided by the non-restrictive modifier is used to establish coherence relations. The fact that cobras are poisonous is understood to be the reason why the speaker does not want them to be mentioned again in (82a) and the reason why the

[25] The effect is even more pronounced with proper names, as in (i) below.

(i) a. Ton Kosta ??(ton) Papadopoulo na min ton ksana-anaferis.
the Kostas the Papadopoulos SUBJ not him again-mention.
'Do not mention Kostas Papadopoulos again.'
b. Itan o Kostas ??(o) Papadopoulos pu me voithise.
was the Kostas the Papadoulos that me helped
'It was Kostas Papadopoulos who helped me.'

speaker did not travel to India in (82b). This is an effect of non-restrictivity independent of polydefiniteness; since, unlike restrictive interpretation, non-restrictive modification does not help identify the intended referent, the use of non-restrictive modifiers is justified by establishing different types of coherence relations in a successful discourse. Crucially for current purposes, it is known that prominence interacts with the establishment of different coherence relations. This can be shown by exploiting the fact that pronoun anaphora is sensitive to both prominence and coherence. Consider, e.g., the short discourse in (83) (Stoinić et al. 2017, p.531, (12)). If the pronoun *him* is resolved to Phil (the most prominent antecedent introduced by a DP in subject position), the two utterances are taken to stand in a cause-effect relation (Liz poked Phil *because* he tickled Stanley). If, on the other hand, the pronoun is resolved to Stanley (the less prominent antecedent introduced by a DP in object position), the two utterances are taken to be in a resemblance relation.[26]

(83) Phil tickled Stanley. Liz poked him.

If, as we propose, polydefiniteness independently determines prominence ranking, we expect polydefiniteness to interact in observable ways with anaphora resolution and the establishment of different coherence relations. As a starting point, consider (84), an example of the same type as (83) above. (84) can either be taken to receive a cause-effect interpretation, if the subject pronoun (an unpronounced *pro* in a pro-drop language such as Greek), is taken to refer to the new employee. If, on the other hand, the subject pronoun refers to Maria, the relation is reversed to effect-cause.

(84) I kenurgia ipalilos itan poli eknevrismeni me tin Maria.
the new employee was very upset with the Mary
'The new employee is very upset with Mary.'
Tis milise asxima.
her talked badly
'She talked badly to her.'

We observe that this second interpretation is disfavoured if the subject DP is polydefinite, as in (85). This is predicted if polydefiniteness forces the referent of the subject DP to be the most prominent entity, irrespective of other considerations. If so, it becomes exceedingly difficult for the *pro* subject to not pick up the new employee as its value and, hence, force the cause-effect interpretation.

(85) I kenurgia i ipalilos itan poli eknevrismeni me tin Maria.
the new the employee was very upset with the Mary
'The new employee is very upset with Mary.'
Tis milise asxima.
her talked badly
'She talked badly to her.'

The licensing of coherence relations via prominence is arguable the reason behind the use of polydefiniteness in cases like (57) and (58). In (57), the car being new is taken to be significant

[26] Stoinić et al. (2017) suggest that establishing the intended coherence relation is a grammatical means of prominence ranking. We do not need to commit to any particular analysis of such effects here. What is crucial for us is that such effects can be used to establish the hypothesis that polydefiniteness is itself an independent way to mark prominence.

in establishing the reasons of Natalia's behaviour. In (58), prominence leads to an interpretation according to which the relevant individual went out despite the weather being cold.

Prominence-marking as understood here can also be taken to underlie certain restrictions on the distribution of polydefiniteness. Prominence ranks particular individuals that have been introduced in the discourse or are introduced by the polydefinite itself in cases of novel definites with existential import. This predicts that polydefiniteness will only be licit with definites that refer to such particular individuals. Consider, first, the case of measure nouns in pseudo-partitive constructions like *tria kila mila* 'three kilos of apples'. It is known that such phrases can give rise to either an individual or quantity interpretation. We observe that polydefinite pseudo-partitives in Greek are only licit in examples that allow the individual-denoting reading, as in (86), and prohibited in examples that force the quantity-denoting reading, as in (87).

(86) Ta tria (ta) kila (ta) mila pu eferes spiti extes
the three the kilos the apples that brought.2SG home yesterday
ine poli nostima.
are very tasty
'The three kilos of apples you brought home yesterday are very tasty.'

(87) Ta tria (#ta) kila (#ta) mila pu zitai i sintagi
the three the kilos the apples that asks.3SG the recipe
ine para pola.
are too many
'The three kilos of apples the recipe asks for is too much.'

Commented [A2]: This is not borne out from the questionnaire, they recieve the same score, 5.5

Consider, next, the case of superlatives in (88) and (89). Whereas polydefinitesness is, in principle, possible with superlatives, as in (88), polydefiniteness becomes impossible in (89) when the polydefinite appears in the argument position of an intensional verb like *psahno* 'look for' which does not entail the existence of the object (Examples from Tsakali 2008 via Alexiadou 2014).[27]

(88) O kaliteros o fititis tha pari ipotrofia.
the best the student will take scholarship
'The best student will take a scholarship.'

(89) O kathigitis psahni ton kalitero (?*to) fititi
the teacher is.looking.for the best the student
gia na tu dosi ipotrofia.
for SUBJ him give scholarship
'The teacher is looking for the best student to give him a scholarship.'

Commented [A3]: We need to be cautious about 89 too. I am not sure it would be that bad.

Consider next superlatives in the scope of a quantificational adverb like *spania* 'seldom'. (90) is ambiguous between a reading according to which the speaker rarely pets a particular cat, which happens to be the smallest in some relevant domain, and a reading in which the speaker

[27] Notice that superlatives and pseudo-partitives (and especially measures phrases like *tria kila* 'three kilos') are additional cases that predication-based analyses of polydefiniteness cannot handle, since there is no plausible predicational structure that could underlie the syntax of these constructions. We do not have the space to go into this issue in detail here.

rarely pets whichever cat is the smallest. As Tsakali (2008) points out, the polydefinite version in (91) disambiguates in favour of the former reading.

(90) Spania xaidevo tin mikroteri gata.
seldom pet the smallest cat
'I seldom pet the smallest cat.'

(91) Spania xaidevo tin mikroteri tin gata.
seldom pet the smallest the cat
'I seldom pet the smallest cat.'

Notice next the contrast between polydefinite superlatives in subject and predicative position. Polydefiniteness is excluded in predicative position. Definites in predicative positions have been claimed to only presuppose uniqueness and not existence (Coppock and Beaver 2015).

(92) O kaliteros o fititis ine apo tin Athina.
the best the student is from the Athens
'The best student is from Athens.'

(93) O Janis ine o kaliteros (*o) fititis.
the John is the best the student
'John is the best student.'

Definite DPs as arguments of inalienable possession *eho* 'have' also have no existential import. As Tsakali (2008) points out polydefiniteness is excluded here.[28]

(94) O Gianis xhi tin megali (*tin) miti tu patera tu.
the John has the big the nose the father his
'John has his father's big nose.'

Tsakali (2008) (cf. Alexiadou 2014) presents more cases of this sort. These authors show that clitic doubling is infelicitous in the same environments and attribute this common distribution to the Familiarity Condition. We have shown that the Familiarity Condition is too strong for polydefinites, however. We leave it open whether a prominence-based account of the sort advocated here for polydefiniteness could be extended to clitic doubling or not.

3. Conclusions

In this paper we have challenged some of the major trends in the literature on Greek polydefiniteness. On the empirical side, we have challenged the pervasive claim that Greek polydefinites obligatorily give rise to a restrictive interpretation. We have shown that the adjectival restrictions that are supposed to follow from this generalization do not hold, even when one restricts themselves to cases of contrast/ restrictivity. Moreover, we have shown that, once the scattered cases of non-restrictive cases of polydefinites previously mentioned in the literature are put in focus and are properly contextualized, it becomes evident that the

[28] See Tsakali (2008) for more cases of this sort. Tsakali (2008) (cf. Alexiadou 2014) show that clitic doubling is also out in the same environments and attribute this common distribution to the Familiarity Condition. We have shown that the Familiarity Condition is too strong for polydefinites. We leave it open whether a prominence-based account could be extended to clitic doubling or not.

distribution of polydefiniteness is far wider than previously thought. We have substantiated these claims by presenting the results of a questionnaire checking the availability of non-restrictive uses of polydefiniteness and establishing that, their availability is comparable to if not better from the corresponding monadic definites. Furthermore, we have shown that when the right contexts are used we can multiply the cases of felicitous uses of non-intersective adjectives in polydefinites. These results have important analytical consequences. We have shown that no existing analysis, as it stands, can capture the wide distribution of polydefiniteness. As far as we can see the only existing analysis that can be appropriately modified to cover all felicitous cases is the apposition-based analysis of Lekakou and Szendrői (2012). We proposed a version of this analysis that does not force intersective semantics in the analysis of modification and can be extended to all the felicitous cases. We developed this proposal in the framework of Dynamic Syntax, which allows us to unify the analysis of all cases in terms of underspecification and the linking of two distinct structures. A key characteristic of this proposal is that the truth-conditional contribution of a polydefinite is indistinguishable from that of the corresponding monadic definite. In the second part of our proposal, however, we argued that polydefinites and monadic definites differ in terms of discourse structure. Previous proposals in this domain only considered discourse structure in terms of the necessary conditions that license polydefiniteness. We argued instead that the licensing conditions of polydefinites are identical to that of definites (whatever those are exactly). The crucial difference between the two is that polydefinites are markers of prominence in the sense of Heusinger and Schumacher (2019); i.e. they dynamically change the structure of discourse. We believe that this proposal is flexible enough to capture the full range of different contexts in which polydefiniteness is possible and restrictive enough to derive some known restrictions on the distribution of polydefiniteness. At the same time, we believe that a more extensive investigation of the pragmatic and discourse structural effects associated with polydefiniteness can lead to a more refined and sophisticated proposal. We hope that our paper has demonstrated that this is a fruitful direction to pursue.

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Appendix A: multiple definites with epithets

Another case of felicitous non-restrictive uses of polydefinites is that of epithets (Manolessou 2000). Consider example (1). If the adjective *eksipnos* 'smart' is understood in its usual interpretation, (1) favours (in out-of-the-blue contexts) a restrictive interpretation, as described for other adjectives in the main text. However, *eksipnos* can also receive an expressive interpretation 'smart-ass'. In this case (1) is understood non-restrictively, even in out-of-the-blue contexts. In fact, the expressive interpretation is favoured when polydefiniteness is used.

(1) o eksipnos o adelfos mu
the clever the brother my
'my brother the wise-ass'

We checked the availability of polydefiniteness with *eksipnos* in contexts that favour the expressive interpretation as in (2). In this case, the polydefinite clearly out-scores the monadic definite. In the non-restrictive context of (2), the monadic definite in (3) received an average score of 6,8 and the polydefinite in (4) received an average score of 8,7.

(2) Context: Maria has a brother who claims that the Earth is flat. Maria's best friend, Antonia, is a theoretical physicist with a PhD in astrophysics. One day, Antonia was explaining to Maria how absurd the notion of a flat Earth is. Maria then said…
(3) Ston eksipno aderfo mu na ta pis afta
To.the smart brother my SUBJ them tell these
'Tell that to my brother the smartass'
(4) Ston eksipno ton aderfo mu na ta pis afta
To.the smart the brother my SUBJ them tell these
'Tell that to my brother the smartass.'

We concur with Alexiadou (2014), Chatzykiriakidis (2015) who treats such cases as epithets. Epithets exhibit a meaning shift of the adjective, a coercion into a meaning which is not the adjective's literal meaning and is expressive in the sense of Potts (2005). One could perhaps envisage a link between prominence marking and the use of the evaluative, emotive language employed in epithets. There are reasons, however, to treat polydefiniteness with epithets as a distinct phenomenon. Perhaps, the most compelling evidence concerns word order. In cases like (5) the noun can be split from the epithet by the intervention of other material between *det + N* and *det + A*. This is not allowed in other cases of polydefinites, like, e.g. (6).

(5) Ston aderfo mu na ta pis afta ton eksipno.
To.the brother my SUBJ them tell these the
'Tell that to my brother the smartass.'

(6) *I gates dhen ton simpathusan i mavres.
the cats not him liked the black.
'The black cats didn't like him.'

Epithets show a behaviour reminiscent of R-expressions, being subject to principle C (Higginbotham 1985, Lasnik and Stowell 1991 among others). Alexiadou (2014) presents further evidence that the adjectives in these cases have nominal properties. We take the syntactic evidence plus the semantic evidence, which point to a coerced meaning of the adjective akin to the expressive content associated with epithets to point to the fact that these constructions are not real polydefinites and, thus, should not be expected to behave in the same manner as polydefinites. We refer to Alexiadou (2014) for an account of definiteness marking in such cases.